4.4.3.6. Acknowledged Message Counter (32 bits)

An optional, unsigned integer value containing the message counter of a previous message that is being acknowledged by the current message. The Acknowledged Message Counter field is SHALL only be present when the A Flag in the Exchange Flags field is 1.

4.4.3.7. Secured Extensions (variable)

The Secured Extensions field is a variable length block of data for providing backwards compatible extensibility. The format of the Secured Extensions block is shown in Table 15, "Secured Extensions block format definition". The Secured Extensions block SHALL be present only if the SX Flag is set to 1 in the Exchange Flags field.

Version 1.0 Nodes SHALL ignore the contents of the Secured Extensions payload.

The Secured Extensions block SHALL be encrypted and authenticated based on the Security Flags settings.

Table 15. Secured Extensions block format definition

Length	Field
2 bytes	Secured Extensions Payload Length, in bytes.
variable	[Secured Extensions Payload]

4.4.3.8. Application Payload (variable length)

A sequence of zero or more bytes containing the application data conveyed by the message.

4.4.4. Message Size Requirements

Support for IPv6 fragmentation is not mandatory in Matter, and the expected supported MTU is 1280 bytes, the minimum required by IPv6. Therefore, all messages, including transport headers, SHALL fit within that minimal IPv6 MTU. This message size limit SHALL apply to the UDP transport . A message received over UDP that exceeds this message size limit SHALL NOT be processed. Messages sent over TCP, PAFTP, NTL, or BTP transports MAY exceed the message size limit if both nodes are capable of supporting larger message sizes.

4.5. Message Framing Over Stream-Oriented Transports

When Matter messages are transferred over stream-oriented transport protocols, such as TCP, PAFTP, or BTP, they need to be framed appropriately to enable the receiver to read each message from the stream. To allow that, each Matter Message SHALL be prepended with a Message Length field. This field SHALL only be present when the message is being transmitted over a stream-oriented channel. When transmitted over a datagram channel, such as UDP or NTL, the message length SHALL be conveyed by the underlying channel. For example, when transmitted over UDP, the message length SHALL be equal to the payload length of the UDP datagram.

